

LADDER SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Control fall, slip and overturn hazards.

8-10 MINUTES

OBJECTIVE

Ensure the safe use of portable and fixed ladders while preventing falls, slips, overturning and misuse.

TOPIC EXPLANATION

- Use ladders only for short-duration, low-risk work.
- Inspect ladders before use and remove damaged ladders from service.
- Apply the 4:1 rule, maintain three points of contact and position the ladder on stable ground.

REALISTIC SITE SCENARIO

- A worker overreached while standing on the top step of a ladder.
- The ladder slipped and the worker fell.
- Correct positioning and repositioning the ladder would have prevented the incident.

REMEMBER

A ladder provides access, not a work platform.

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8-10 MINUTES

Hazards, safe use and daily pre-work verification.

KEY HAZARDS

- Damaged ladders
- Incorrect angle
- Unstable ground
- Standing on the top step
- Overreaching
- Metal ladders near electricity
- Unsecured ladders
- Carrying loads while climbing

CONTROL MEASURES

- Inspect before use.
- Apply the 4:1 rule.
- Maintain three points of contact.
- Secure the ladder.
- Do not stand on the top step.
- Reposition instead of overreaching.
- Use fiberglass ladders near electricity.
- Check anti-slip feet.
- Remove damaged ladders from service.
- Barricade the area if necessary.

SUPERVISOR TALKING SCRIPT

Today all ladders will be inspected before use. We will apply the 4:1 rule, maintain three points of contact and never work from the top step.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Has the ladder been inspected?
- Is the 4:1 rule applied?
- Is the ladder secured?
- Is the ground stable?
- Is there an electrical hazard?
- Will three points of contact be maintained?

VERIFY BEFORE STARTING TODAY

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Ladder inspected | ☐ Rungs intact |
| ☐ Anti-slip feet OK | ☐ Correct angle |
| ☐ Ladder secured | ☐ Ground stable |
| ☐ Electrical hazard assessed | ☐ Three-point contact |
| ☐ PPE worn | ☐ Team briefed |

ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

LADDER SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Project / Site

Date

Presented by

Work area

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
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Supervisor notes